

A Stalled Revolution:

What Maslow's Peace Table Could Have Been

And what we can do about it now, fifty years later

Despite what you might have been told, transformative, even revolutionary, visions are not that rare. In fact, respected founding father of Humanistic *and* Transpersonal Psychology, Abraham Maslow, argued that people had them all the time

In my first investigations... I used this word because I thought some people had peak-experiences and others did not. But as I gathered information, and as I became more skillful in asking questions, I found that a higher and higher percentage of my subjects began to report peak-experiences... I finally fell into the habit of expecting everyone to have peak-experiences and of being rather surprised if I ran across somebody who could report none at all. Because of this experience, I finally began to use the word 'non-peaker' to describe, not the person who is unable to have peak-experiences, but rather the person who is afraid of them, who suppresses them, who denies them, who turns away from them, or who 'forgets' them (Maslow 2012:340–41).

Maslow himself even had such vision, more than once. On December 7, 1941, a day after Pearl Harbour, he experienced a vision that redirected his entire life (Hoffman 1999). He saw a Peace Table where humanity gathered to understand itself, to heal, and to finally break the cycles of violence that had defined civilization for so long. A psychology not of pathology and control, but one devoted to the full actuation of [Human Potential](#). A psychology that could not only end all war but that would shortly bring about what Maslow called [Eupsychia](#), or the Good Society (Maslow 1961), a happy society of happy people who are happily busy realizing their full potential. Utopia, by any other name.

In addition to that defining vision, Maslow also had motivation vision when he was a student when he took what he characterized as a vow to do something big, specifically to make big contributions to philosophy, psychology, and anthropology. In his own words:

One night when I was all alone in the furniture place at which I was working part-time as a night watchman, I experienced while reading *Folkways* a big breakthrough of awe and admiration. It was a kind of cold chill and hair-standing-on-end peak-experience. I was not merely happy; I also felt a sense of the uncanny and of littleness, incapability, and the like.

The point is that my vow—that's what it would have been called 500 years ago—was also a resolution: to do like Sumner. I swore that I would try to make a similar contribution to philosophy, psychology, and anthropology. Why these three particular fields, I don't remember. But that evening, my ethnocentrism dropped away like old clothes, and I became a citizen of the world.

If I had been in King Arthur's court, I suppose that I would have kept vigil beside my sword and before an altar all night long. That was exactly the spirit of it. In any case, that's what I've done with my life. (Maslow 1996a:20)

I don't know who he was bowing to that night, God, an ancestor, Archangel Michael, and abstract idea of service (most likely the latter given his materialist tendencies), but the grandeur of the experience and the solemnity of his feelings are quite clear. Like Sir Lancelot of the Round Table, he devoted his life to doing something really, really big. Specifically, he chose to develop an empirically grounded conceptualization of humanity, a new narrative root for our collective image of self. No minor adjustments here. He wanted a "new image of [humanity], of society, of nature, of science, of ultimate values, of philosophy, etc., etc." and he wanted it applied to all areas (political, economic, social, institutional, etc) of life—an integrated, holistic 'humanistic' *Weltanschauung*" (Maslow 1970). This would be the foundation for his new psychology and the global peace he desired.

Was this novel?

Surprisingly, no. Sociological founding Father **Auguste Comte** tried exactly the same thing with his "positive philosophy" and "positive politics." He actually wrote an entire catechism which he thought would form the moral and ethical basis for his system that he felt could guide humanity forward. I don't know if he had a vision, but he definitely had a plan. He wanted to provide a moral, social order,

and societal order (a [Comprehensive Framework](#), we might say) that could guide the world towards a “real Providence,” as he said (Comte 1852:1).

Whas it ambitious?

Absolutely. Like Comte, Maslow wasn’t looking for incremental change. He wanted to change the direction of humanity.

Did he do it?

Yes, and no.

I would say he successfully conceived of his new psychology. He said it himself.

There is now available a new conception, of a higher possibility, of the healthy society.

There are tools now available to judge and compare societies. One society can be judged to be better than another society, or healthier or possessing more 'growth-fostering-potential.'

We can talk about the value of the society, or the function of the society—that is, the greatest coming to fulfillment of the people in the society (Maslow 1969:7).

I would also say that it was successfully nurtured several steps towards birth. By the time of his death he had mapped **out the theoretical foundation for Eupsychia and help implement its three pillars.** Humanistic Psychology, Transpersonal Psychology, and a third, nascent, [Eupsychian Psychology](#). The three pillars of his peace table.

Unfortunately, however, the birth was aborted. Maslow died in 1970, prematurely at sixty-two, after which the entire humanistic and transpersonal movement he helped ignite fizzled out, not because it had lost some great driving force (many others were carrying the torch) but because it was ignored, resisted, marginalized, and systematically defunded.

Maslow himself was aware of many of these problems. He railed against the “disgusting” commercial press, representing as they do the “intellectual establishment,” were completely ignoring the revolution.

...The Atlantic Monthly, Harper, The Saturday Review (that is the best of them, but it’s not very good), and the *New York Review of Books* (which is definitely the worst). All of these mass-circulation periodicals reveal the entire intellectual establishment’s alienation and its

total lack of knowledge about the emerging new intellectual synthesis. I was thinking this morning: Where are the great names from among the humanists today? These magazines never even mention them. Where are Carl Rogers, Gordon Allport, Henry Murray, and Gardner Murphy, let alone the younger people like Michael Murphy

For two, it was resisted within the academy, primarily on the basis of its association with “mystical” experience. Again, Maslow was aware. He pointed out that people resisted core concepts, like the concept of peak experience, because of prejudicial, pessimistic, and narrowly “rationalistic attitude[s]” (Maslow 1962:15)

For three, it was systematically defunded and marginalized (Elkins 2009), the visionary impulse and emancipatory drive effectively suppressed. Elkins documents this as “murder.”

Of course, personal and structural factors were not the only impediments. Maslow was attempting a monumental theoretical and practical feat, but he was doing so with primitive [Knowledge Technology](#) (Sosteric 2025c). All Maslow had was a typewriter to work with. and a resistant corporate media to distribute. Consequently, theoretical development and deployment was...

- **Slow**, for obvious reasons. As editing tools, Typewriter’s are simply not. On them, writing is slow and cumbersome. If you need to change a sentence, you have to retype the whole thing.
- **Choppy and uneven**. Maslow, for example, modified his needs theory (Maslow 1943b, 1943a). **throughout his career (Sosteric and Ratkovic 2020)**

Ossified. Despite the fact that Maslow added substantively to his needs theory, he could never ever back and edit his 1943 articles even if he had time. They are always there as the canonical ground of his theory, no matter how inadequate they might now be.

- **Inorganic**. Updates were incredibly difficult and time consuming to make difficult. Any updates he might have provided required books (Maslow 1954) and book revisions (Maslow 1970).

Couple all that with resistance and suppression and we can see why the revolution failed. Technological and social conditions weren’t optimal and it was resisted by the powers that be.

Which is too bad.

Tragic really.

The general population might not appreciate it now, and the significance of Maslow may be lost to most modern psychologists, but he built something quite special, something I believe capable of grounding Eupsychia. Something capable of moving American society, and the world for that matter, forward towards peace. The prescriptions weren't particularly new. But the theoretical framework he was developing was grand. Had it been allowed to grow it would almost certainly have revolutionized humanity's view of itself.

Consider where we might be today, empirically, theoretically, and practically had things been supported and not suppressed.

Consider the healing that didn't happen.

Consider the human potential unrealized.

Oh well.

No sense crying over spilled milk,

The question we must ask today is **can we do something about it?**

The answer is, yes.

Yes we can do something about it. We can use advanced **Knowledge Technology** to help recover.

Maslow had a typewriter, pen, and paper. He had no mind-mapping software, no AI research assistants, no semantic visualization tools to help him organize revolutionary complexity. He had no internet, no social media, no global distribution network beyond corporate-controlled publishers who had zero interest in revolutionary psychology. He had no collaborative platforms, no version control, no way for a global community to evolve his framework in real-time.

What he achieved with primitive tools is almost incomprehensible. But what we can achieve with modern Knowledge Technology—**that** could change everything.

I know, because I've been building it.

Since 2005, I've been constructing a Knowledge System designed to do exactly what Maslow dreamed: create a structured, dynamic, transdisciplinary architecture for the creation, organization, validation, and dissemination of knowledge (Sosteric 2025b). It began as a scholarly notebook to understand my own mystical experiences (Sosteric 2022), but evolved into something far more ambitious—a semantically linked theoretical system integrating insights from Maslow, Rogers, Grof, Fromm, and others who dedicated their lives to understanding human potential.

Today, it's a fully operational Knowledge System focused on human development and potential. A system designed to solve Maslow's Big Problems.

Characteristics? This is where it gets exciting.

The SpiritWiki—our Knowledge System—has:

- **Strict quality control.** Only verified experts edit, and only in their domains. No Wikipedia-style chaos, no ideological vandalism.
- **Live evolution.** Theoretical advances can be incorporated within hours, not decades. When new research emerges, the system adapts immediately.
- **Canonical authority.** The structure resists corruption. It's designed to become the planetary reference, the trusted source that cannot be easily manipulated or commercialized.
- **Open access.** Free to duplicate, distribute, and translate globally. No corporate gatekeepers can suppress it.
- **Semantic depth.** Every concept is interlinked, creating a web of meaning rather than isolated facts. You can trace how "Seven Essential Needs" connects to "Quantum Substrate Integrity" and "Eupsychian Politics" in real-time.

This isn't theoretical. It's operational. The foundation is built. The scaffolding is strong.

Seems like a tall order? It is. But we're not starting from scratch.

I propose we pick up exactly where Maslow left off—not just honoring his vision, but **implementing it** with tools that make suppression nearly impossible.

Let's establish Maslow's Peace Table, right here, right now. Initially in digital space, but expanding as we grow. Here, scholars, practitioners, healers, and revolutionaries can gather to:

- Talk openly about what we need to know
- Design what we need to build (new institutions, new pedagogies, new economies)
- Create the healthy, happy, fully-actualized humans capable of manifesting Maslow's Eupsychia

We'll root it in Maslow's seminal work and the contributions of other giants—Comte, Fromm, Grof, Rogers, Horney, May. But we'll move beyond, adding our own empirical, theoretical, and even mystical insights (Sosteric 2022).

Together, we'll build what Maslow dreamed of building—not as historical curiosity, but as **living revolution**.

We are about to lose everything we've worked for. The polycrisis is accelerating.

What else are we going to do?

The tools are here. The vision is clear. The need is urgent.

Let's build.

I have been building this system since 2005. started as a scholarly notebook to help me understand my mystical experience (Sosteric 2022) . gradually evolved into a semantically linked theoretical system integrates insights of [key figures](#) , people have contributed significantly to understanding, refinement, distribution of human potential and [Human Nature](#). Now it is a knowledge system focussed on the topics of human development and human potential. Designed to provide framework for solving maslow's Big Problems. In it can find concept, ideas, interlinked, theoretical, empirical grounding characteristics and benefit

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